Journal of Destination Marketing & Management 32 (2024) 100876

Contents lists available at ScienceDirect

Journal of Destination Marketing & Management

journal homepage: www.elsevier.com/locate/jdmm

Discovering flamenco show audience tourists' profile: Sentiment analysis, opinions and attitudes

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ARTICLE INFO

Keywords:
Flamenco
Tourists' profiles
Sentiment analysis
Artificial neural networks
Multilayer perceptron

ABSTRACT

The aim of this work is to unveil the relationships between the socio-demographic profile of tourists attracted by flamenco shows and their opinions and perceptions about the importance of music in general and flamenco in particular as a motivation to travel, their interest and preference for flamenco and flamenco shows. The methodology employed is an artificial neural network to estimate a specific socio-demographic profile of tourists interested in attending flamenco shows, taking as the basis the prearranged input values, that is, the responses to Likert questions gathered through a survey. The network allows these responses to be customised, obtaining a "composite sketch" of the tourists' socio-demographic profile determined based on these responses.

1. Introduction

Flamenco is a mixture of Andalusian, North African, Latin American and Indian cultures (Leblon, 2003). Regarding dance, its influence comes from three sources: the culture of Spain, and specifically Andalusia (its southern region), which gives it grace and elegance; the gipsy culture, contributing to the temperament; and the interpretative force of the black African culture, from whom the sensuality of the swaggers and their binary rhythms are collected (Navarro, 2008). Each flamenco style (or, in Spanish, 'palo') is considered to express a different type of emotion, from the most profound and tragic to the festive and joyful (Machin-Autenrieth, 2015). The flamenco's imprint has contributed significantly to becoming a distinctive symbol of the Andalusian region and Spain. This distinction positions it as an influential factor that drives international demand and leads to a growth in the arrival of tourists interested in the art of flamenco or simply curious to discover it (Aragú & Mestanza, 2022).

Thrill-seeking tourism constitutes a significant section of the tourism sector in Spain, specifically in the province of Córdoba (within Andalusia region). Tourists show a growing interest in the living experiences on their trips or visits to get directly involved with the destination they visit. This memorable tourist experience was found to affect tourists' behavioural intentions, such as intention to revisit, and interest in recommending to others (Sharma & Nayak, 2019; Sthapit et al., 2020; Zhong et al., 2017). Additionally, emotions are closely linked to the value of personality and a brand's identity. In flamenco's case, the feelings it generates and transmits remain connected to its culture.

The aim of this work is to unveil the relationships between the socio-demographic profile (educational level, income, age and gender) of tourists attracted by flamenco shows and their opinions and perceptions about the importance of music in general and flamenco in particular as a motivation to travel, their interest and preference for attending flamenco shows and for flamenco in general.

The methodology employed is an artificial neural network (ANN) of the multilayer perceptron (MLP) type (Rumelhart et al., 1986) to forecast a specific socio-demographic profile of tourists interested in attending flamenco shows taken as the basis the prearranged input values that is the responses to Likert questions through a survey. Thus, the network allows these responses to be customised, obtaining a 'composite sketch' of the tourists' profile made up of specific output values that correspond to a socio-demographic profile determined based on these responses. In addition, the network allows assessing the changes experimented in the Likert scale of each item corresponding to every one of the characteristics included in the socio-demographic profile. The ANN employment in tourism research to estimate profiles is still recent, and its presence in the literature remains scarce (García-García et al., 2023; Moral-Cuadra et al., 2021, 2022). Thus, one of the greatest innovations of this research is the use of this methodology to

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https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jdmm.2024.100876
Received 18 December 2022; Received in revised form 31 January 2024; Accepted 29 February 2024
Available online 6 March 2024
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analyse the socio-demographic profile of tourists interested in attending flamenco shows based on their opinions, perceptions, motivations, and preferences.

This paper is structured as follows. First, Section 2 deals with the literature review on the topic (thrill-seeking tourism, music as tourist motivation, flamenco, Socio-demographic profile of music tourism). Section 3 explains the methodology used, considering the survey procedure and data analysis. Section 4 presents the descriptives and the ANN performance results. Section 5 deals with the discussion, and finally, Section 6 includes the conclusions (theoretical and practical implications), limitations and future lines of research.

2. Literature review

2.1. Thrill-seeking tourism

The tourist seeks to enjoy and escape, searching for a link with the individuals of the destination and their traditions (Park & Santos, 2017). Generally, tourists travel attracted and interested by the external forces of the destination (Yoo et al., 2018). In tourism, the importance of emotions is highlighted (Rahmani et al., 2019). Thus, at the individual level, emotions play a central role in creating memorable experiences (Knobloch et al., 2017).

Stakeholders need to promote emotional expectations, tourism experiences and post-trip evaluation (Volo, 2021) because positive emotions affect behaviours related to a possible return visit (Pestana et al., 2020). In addition, studies confirm that high levels of positive emotion produce tourist well-being and low levels of negative emotion (Filep & Laing, 2019), although the importance of negative emotions in the tourist experience must be taken into account in the design and destination management (Zhang et al., 2021).

In experiential tourism, the tourist contributes to some aspect, procedure or general tourist experience, actively participates in the background, interacts with other people during the experience and becomes involved in it (Campos et al., 2018). This line in active participation conceives the tourist not as someone who wants only to watch but interact, actively learning, applying knowledge (Tan et al., 2013, 2014). Aspects such as novelty and surprise must be considered in tourism since they have a significant effect on emotional and memorable tourist experiences (Hosany et al., 2015; Skavronskaya et al., 2019). The role of shared emotions should be considered, as they constitute a fundamental component in most experiences (Wood, 2019).

Studies that focus on aspects such as authenticity, personal identity, social interactions, skill acquisition and the learning process point to an underlying purpose in the tourist experience: the creation of symbolic meaning through the trip to forge one's own identity and facilitate learning (Rickly & McCabe, 2017; Scuttari & Pechlaner, 2017; Volo, 2017).

Regarding experience analysis, it has gradually moved to the mode of studying emotional experience and sensory experiences (Chen et al., 2018; Tercia et al., 2019). Music's auditory pleasure will make listeners enjoy the experience (Loepthien & Leipold, 2022). Furthermore, the tourist who travels motivated by music demands authenticity of the destination and seeks memorable experiences (Kim & Ritchie, 2014).

2.2. Music as tourist motivation

Music is a motivation for tourist to travel (Revilla Pacheco & Ramírez Fernández, 2015) and also musical events' participation (Getz & Page, 2016), helping to develop local markets (Kruger & Saayman, 2019; Semrad & Rivera, 2018). This tourist values what is different and memorable (Prebensen et al., 2016). Music is culture, an art form that has inspired music tourism, a market with different potential niches (Friel & Segre, 2023; Lee & How, 2023). Thus, a growing number of cultural tourists are seeking significant experiences through music (Revilla Pacheco & Ramírez Fernández, 2015), and the participation of tourists in musical events has enlarged (Getz & Page, 2016).

Jiang et al. (2018) divided tourists' perceptions of the destination's soundscape into images with affective and cognitive components and showed that both significantly affect tourist loyalty. These satisfactory experiences will affect the behavioural intentions of the visitors and the development of the festivals (Semrad & Rivera, 2018). The musical experience encompasses various attributes and fulfils social and psychological functions, fostering empathy and promoting an emotional experience in listeners (Groarke & Hogan, 2020). Therefore, following Crompton (2003), this experience provides socio-psychological benefits that enrich the experience of festival attendees.

Additionally, each generation defines its identity through music, so products and experiences that increase it are offered (Lashua, et al., 2014). Also, festivals have an impact on the economy and tourism of the territory in which the event is held, having not only cultural and social effects (Pérez-Gálvez, Lopez-Guzman, Gomez-Casero, & Fruet Cardozo, 2017). Attendee involvement, achieved through commitment and participation in the festival, is a crucial motivation for attending festivals, and the importance of social interaction has been considered a valuable and significant dimension of the tourist experience (Ellis et al., 2019; Hudson et al., 2015). Likewise, the attendees' satisfaction and behaviour influence the festival's perceived quality (Wong et al., 2015; Wu & Ai, 2016; Wu et al., 2014).

Therefore, the new experimental tourist seeks authenticity in their destination, having greater knowledge regarding cultural tourist destinations, so the tourist offer seems unexciting, and they need unforgettable experiences (Kim & Ritchie, 2014). Jiang (2022) argued that the perceived image of a soundscape affects visitors' emotional arousal and well-being. It is essential to create new products with which the visitor is an active subject (Mowinckel, 2016) who interacts and gets involved in the experience (Campos et al., 2018) in a mental, physical or emotional manner (Bertella, 2014), including the passion, referred to the behaviours of positive emotional expression of consumers, mainly with the expressions of cheers, applause and jeering of other consumers (Kim et al., 2019). Engagement also includes interaction between attendees and those who attend the festival (Brown et al., 2020; Brown & Sharpley, 2019). Therefore, a relationship is confirmed between commitment and the intention to return to future festival editions (Vittersø et al., 2017).

There are multiple musical genres related to tourism, such as music representative of different regions (Elliott, 2017; Lee & How, 2023), popular music named after physical spaces or cities (Lv et al., 2023; Yin et al., 2020), original film soundtracks (Kirby, 2021; Nanjangud & Reijnders, 2022) or music that evokes landscapes and narratives (Milburn, 2019). Specifically, participating in the experience by visiting symbolic places of emblematic artists, such as Graceland in Memphis or the John Lennon Memorial in Central Park, allows for reliving the emotions associated with that particular music (Agarwal, et al., 2018). Nanjangud and Reijnders (2022) found that Bollywood (India) soundtracks allowed tourists to imagine, experience and visit tourist destinations related to their favourite soundtracks by reconfiguring destination narratives and re-enactments. Similarly, nostalgia and memory join the musical heritage of destinations, which further attracts visitors (Fremaux & Fremaux, 2013). Additionally, the importance of including emotional content within the dissemination and advertising of the destination is highlighted, considering it an influential factor in tourist motivation (Min et al., 2013).

The music of the destination can be a means for potential tourists to form an image of the place and, ultimately, promote their visits to it (Nanjangud & Reijnders, 2022; Yin et al., 2020). The literature exposes a connection between the physical place where they keep their roots and identity and music, such as jazz in New Orleans (USA), tango in Argentina and rumba in Cuba (Thimm, 2014). The latter is similar to cities recognised as the birthplace of celebrities or music groups such as Beatles' Liverpool, Mozart's Salzburg, or the Beethoven's Bonn (Long, 2014). Various tourism kinds of research have been aimed at the visual

component of the tourist experience, mainly focused on the concept of 'tourist gaze' (Dinhopl & Gretzel, 2016; Larsen & Laursen, 2014; Urry, 1992; Woodside & Martin, 2015), a trend that is turning into the 'tourist ear' who travels attracted by music (Thimm, 2014). The perception of cities through their songs will always be present in the mind of tourists (Long, 2014). Some research mentions that music-induced imagination potentially enhances destination images (Yin et al., 2020), evokes immersive experiences (Chen et al., 2019), and attracts tourists to visit these destinations (Friel & Segre, 2023). Music could be the main attraction for attending a particular cultural performance (Wood & Kinnunen, 2020).

2.3. Flamenco

It is necessary to reinforce the understanding of Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) for different cultures (Poria et al., 2013), especially regarding international destinations (Tucker & Carnegie, 2014). The motivations of the tourist have been studied as a moderating effect of the place recognition as World Heritage Site (WHS), specifically, the case of the Sagrada Familia (Forgas-Coll et al., 2012). Analogous to what happens with flamenco, an attribute recognised as ICH by UNESCO, moves tourists to reach to different destinations to rediscover it (Matteucci, 2013; Vergopoulos, 2016). Thus, flamenco, recognised by UNESCO as ICH, became an incentive to travel to Spain. In addition, the tourist interested in flamenco usually desires to experience it beyond the simple show. He/she could be interested in learning and practising dancing, singing or playing any of the instruments and learning more about the history of flamenco and the individuals involved.

There is a growing international recognition of flamenco as an art to enjoy, perform or learn. Furthermore, the evolution of flamenco in its fusion with other musical styles or the incorporation of instruments from different cultures is another opportunity to attract new devotees (Millán Vázquez de la Torre et al., 2016). In this line, flamenco involves both solid local and global components, achieving popularity in countries far away from Spain as Japan, the United States, and in parts of Europe (United Kingdom, France and Italy) or Latin America and North Africa (Palma et al., 2017).

Flamenco festivals held in other countries contribute to the internationalisation of flamenco since, generally, all audience and media coverage has an international scope; the artistic company moves to different countries, which generates foreign and personal income and creative enrichment, developing new capacities that ease the internationalisation process (Rastrollo-Horrillo & Navarrete, 2020). At a music festival, the flamenco performance can become a key to the memory of the tourist experience. For instance, it could take place in the selection of specific themes that bring back to remembering the festival, recreating the mood of the festival, and help to recreate again a feeling of belonging to the public who attended the festival or with the performers (Wood & Kinnunen, 2020).

In addition to their core audience, the festivals also attract tourists in Spain for various reasons and are looking to participate in cultural activities to enrich their travel experience. This dynamic creates an opportunity to expand the reach of flamenco to new audiences. Consequently, Spanish festivals can play a crucial role in the internationalisation of flamenco by attracting both artists and international audiences (Rastrollo-Horrillo & Navarrete, 2020).

Additionally, not only tourists come to Andalusia, a region in the south of Spain, to experience flamenco, but the artists also teach and perform at flamenco festivals outside of Spain. In Japan, some 80,000 people study flamenco in around 600 academies (Matteucci, 2018). Flamenco is an influential driver of tourist activity, attracting more than 600,000 tourists each year who seek the beauty, heartbreak and authenticity of art that originated in Spain, which identifies favourably against other competing tourist destinations (Consejería de Turismo y Deporte de la Junta de Andalucía, 2004).

Regarding popular music and dance, it is possible to appreciate that they are cultural attractions, mobilising many tourists worldwide. In the case of artistic and cultural performances, it is inevitable to refer to their cultural heritage, which reflects the history and traditions of the peoples, thus giving them their identity and personality, such as the Mexican mariachi, the Argentine tango or the Brazilian samba, the three cultural representations known as WHS by UNESCO. This cultural heritage linked to cultural tourism will facilitate the integration of the tourist in the destination community as they get involved with the heritage and culture, and the union between tourism and identity will be accentuated (Stebbins, 1997).

Among the artistic representations mentioned above is the dance and music scope of the present research: flamenco. Considered a living art, a way of life, perceiving and interpreting daily existence; Leblon (2003) claimed to be composed of a mixture of North African, Latin American and Indian influence: the contribution of the gipsy people from the region of Andalusia, where it keeps its roots and identity. In addition to being a symbol of the identity of Andalusia and Spain, this art was recognised as ICH on November 16, 2010. To transmits the latter, elements based on local history must be included, including locations of death and birth of musicians, museums and festivals (Connell & Gibson, 2004). Andalusia (Spain) is the region considered the origin of flamenco, the birthplace of the most emblematic artists in this discipline, and the region from which it keeps all its identity. The 'identity-linked' nature of flamenco gives this art form a competitive advantage over other performing arts in terms of internationalisation and new strategies supported by social media (Palma et al., 2017).

Between flamenco and Andalusia, there is a connection with the music and the place through which its identity is reiterated, consequently being the identity flagship of Andalusia. Additionally, it is a unique symbol of Spanish culture worldwide. The latter has led to flamenco's image is considered a 'brand Spain' (Palma et al., 2017). With these associations between music, musicians and places, these become capable of being successfully marketed internationally and thus transmit the identity of the cities to tourists, businesses and residents (Long, 2014).

This flamenco's image is considered the primary incentive for an essential section of the foreign tourist market, so a promotion may be successful in Spain if it is remarked as a sign of identity in communication campaigns. Therefore, the role of flamenco as a determinant factor in tourist motivation involves the core features of the experience that the 'flamenco tourist' receives when visiting the tourist destination, which, in any case, is an intangible experience and emotional.

Therefore, when analysing flamenco as a fundamental factor in customer motivation and satisfaction, the main characteristics of the experience received by the 'flamenco tourist' are taken into account, which would be an intangible and emotional experience. Thus, a competitive environment in terms of prices is not currently enough, as the naturalness and simplicity of the moment and the freedom provided by the activity itself are highly valued.

2.4. Socio-demographic profile of music tourism

In event management studies, the segmentation of festival visitors has been analysed based on their demographic, psychographic, geographic, and behavioural traits (Tkaczynski & Rundle-Thiele, 2020). Saragih and Amelia (2020) suggest that music festival attendees can be categorised into three groups: those seeking hedonic well-being (focusing on pleasure and escapism), prudential happiness (focusing on pleasure, escapism, and self-reflection) and eudaimonia (seeking pleasure, escapism, self-reflection, meaning and impact).

Following Fonseca and Ramos (2014), gender, age, level of education, income, occupation, cultural interest and the number of people who live in a household are relevant for the music festival attendants. These factors largely explain the three groups that result from the segmentation carried out by these authors in their study. Namely: music lovers, networkers and tourists. Thus, the first group (music lovers)

presents homogeneous preferences as the majority coincides in choosing the same festival as the most memorable. Conversely, the group called networkers does present a more heterogeneous choice. Additionally, music lovers is a primarily female segment, up to 19 years old, who is still studying secondary education. In contrast, the networkers' group are mostly men, over 20 years old, and attending university. From the third group (tourists), the authors conclude that significative results cannot be extracted due to the disparity of its components.

Kruger and Saayman (2015) analysed attendants who belonged to the so-called Generation Y (born between 1982 and 2002) through research at several South African concerts. They identified three clusters based on their socio-demographic characteristics, behaviour, and reasons for attending music festivals. They called these segments tweens, twixters, and tweeds. Thus, the majority of the tweens group were students and academics (88%), while the group called twixters were students (53%) or professionals (22%). As expected, significantly more components of the tweeds group were professionals (58%). In conclusion, there are apparent differences in the musical preferences of these three segments (Kruger & Saayman, 2015).

These results also correspond with the findings of Rentfrow and Gosling (2006), North and Hargreaves (2007), Selfhout et al. (2009), and Ter Bogt et al. (2011). They found that musical preferences are associated with demographic variables, such as age and socioeconomic status, and differences in the reasons for listening to music.

Studies related to flamenco determined the influences that the socio-demographic profile of flamenco show attendees has on their preferences, sensations, and experiences (García-García et al., 2023). On the other hand, the existence of three motivational dimensions related to flamenco is also shown: first, flamenco experience; second, flamenco brand; and third, flamenco context and musical dimension (Muñoz-Fernández et al., 2023).

3. Methodology

3.1. Survey design and data collection

The survey design has been carried out following the studies provided by the previous scientific literature (Forgas-Coll et al., 2012; Prada Trigo & Armijos, 2016; Prebensen et al., 2013). The draft began with an initial set of items extracted from the scientific literature, which were subject to a filtering process through three different phases: firstly, a researcher specialised in tourism analysed the proposed items; secondly, the resulting questionnaire was reviewed by people interested in flamenco; and thirdly, a pre-test was carried out on 50 people who attend flamenco shows. During the debugging phase, it was detected that some questions were not easily understandable by the respondents, so they were corrected. Therefore, the fieldwork was carried out once the questions had been evaluated and the viability of the questionnaire had been determined, seeking maximum clarity in the questions presented and the greatest adjustment of the answers to achieve the aims set in the investigation, being as specific as possible, preventing the excessive length of the survey.

The questionnaire was structured in two differentiated parts based on and adapted from previous studies: first, seven-point Likert-type questions addressed aspects related to emotions, motivations, perceptions and perceived value related to travel, music and flamenco. Second, questions related to socio-demographic factors, such as age, gender, disposable income and education level, were asked.

To check the reliability of the scale, Cronbach's Alpha test was performed, reaching an alpha of 0.961, a value located above the minimum limits established by Nunnally and Bernstein (1994). On the other hand, a simple lexicon was used to avoid problems associated with the common method bias -CMB- (Podsakoff et al., 2012) so that it was as less complex as possible. Furthermore, the anonymity of the respondents was guaranteed (Ibrahim et al., 2023). Additionally, the Harman's Test was used in order to statistically demonstrate that there is no bias (Fuller et al., 2016). The results obtained in Table 1 show that there are no bias problems and that the data are optimal as the factor presents an explained variance of 37.799% since values of explained variance of the first factor greater than 50% would mean the existence of bias (Podsakoff & Organ, 1986). Fieldwork has been carried out on a significant sample of people in Spain who are interested in flamenco, developed through an online survey carried out from September to November 2020. A total of 278 surveys were obtained, of which 265 were valid.

3.2. Data analysis

The ANN is defined as a network composed of process elements (nodes) with a small information storage capacity (Rumelhart & McClelland, 1986). These units are composed of an input vector (x_1, x_2, …, x_n), with their synaptic weights (w_1, w_2, …, w_n) that are applied to those input vectors using a propagation rule. Applying an activation function to that result determines the value of these nodes, which are grouped into several layers, such as input, intermediate (also called hidden) layers that can be one or more, and output.

Employing SPSS Statistics v.23 software, an ANN of the MLP type is elaborated, where the inputs correspond to the replies to the Likert questions obtained in the questionnaire and the output values to the estimates that the network generated regarding the characteristics of the socio-demographic profile of the potential 'flamenco tourist'. This information is previously coded to obtain numerical values as a response. Different models were tested, finally maintaining the ANN that presented a higher degree of adjustment in terms of coefficient of determination (R^2) and mean absolute percentage error (MAPE).

4. Results

4.1. Flamenco shows audience's socio-demographic profile, opinions and attitudes

The socio-demographic characteristics of the respondents are shown in Table 2. The sample obtained presents a small majority of women. Nearly two out of three respondents are between the ages of 26 and 55. Regarding educational level, a vast majority (about three out of four) are university graduates or have higher degrees. According to net family income, more than 60% of those surveyed have more than €1500 per month. The usual profile matches a middle-aged woman with a medium-high income. The set of Likert-type questions on a scale of 1–7 with their descriptive statistics is shown in Table 3. Some of the most valued questions refer to flamenco, either highlighting it as a WHS (Q09), referring to its essential elements as a show -dance, body movements (Q12, Q13) -, or as a cultural identification factor of Spain (Q17).

4.2. Artificial neural networks model developed

An ANN with a topology (18, 6, 5) is reached, with a hyperbolic tangent as an activation function in the hidden layer and an identity function in the output layer. Table 4 shows the model structure, presenting the previous coding of the output values to get figures as estimates. The network obtained is presented graphically in Fig. 1, which displays the associations between the neurons of the different layers with their synaptic weights. The random subdivision of the sample between the training and test groups is shown in Table 5, as well as the error made, the stopping rule used and the training time of the network.

Table 1
Harman's test.

Factor	Extraction Sums of squared loadings		
	Total	% of variance	% cumulative
1	6.804	37.799	37.799

Table 2
Descriptive statistics of tourist's profile.

Variables	Percentage	Variables	Percentage
Gender		**Educational level**	
Male	41.50%	Primary education	3.40%
Female	58.50%	Secondary education	21.90%
Household income (monthly)		University graduate	41.90%
Less than €700	6.40%	Master/PhD	32.80%
€701 to €1000	9.80%	**Age**	
€1001 to €1500	23.40%	Less than 26 years old	24.90%
€1501 to €2500	28.30%	26–40 years old	35.50%
€2501 to €3500	13.60%	41–55 years old	26.80%
More than €3501	18.50%	More than 56 years old	12.80%

Table 3
Flamenco shows audience's question collection.

Code	Question	Mean	Std. Dev.
Music on travels			
Q01	How important are the culture and music of the destination in selecting it?	5.30	1.62
Q02	How important is the existence of a certain type of native music when choosing the destination of your trip?	4.27	1.93
Musical preferences			
Q03	Blues	3.70	1.86
Q04	Classical	4.12	1.91
Q05	Flamenco	5.66	1.45
Q06	Jazz	3.90	1.91
Reasons to know flamenco on your travels			
Q07	Attend flamenco shows	5.47	1.58
Q08	Search for musical experiences	5.42	1.54
Q09	Flamenco is WHS	6.06	1.54
Q10	Interact with people related to flamenco: singers, dancers, etc.	5.30	1.69
Q11	Buying products related to flamenco: musical instruments, flamenco dresses, etc.	4.31	2.11
Opinions about flamenco shows			
Q12	Dance quality	6.26	1.02
Q13	Body movements	6.19	1.12
General attitudes about flamenco			
Q14	Flamenco increases my desire to visit certain destinations	4.57	1.95
Q15	The possibility of enjoying flamenco in one of its places of origin is an important reason for me	5.48	1.79
Q16	I feel happiness when enjoying a flamenco experience	5.67	1.32
Elements that define Spain as a country			
Q17	Flamenco	6.30	1.09
Q18	Sports	4.80	1.57

Table 6 presents, as a goodness of fit assessment of the ANN, the coefficient of determination (R^2) and the MAPE obtained for each of the dependent variables and their mean. Although the MAPE displays alike values for all the outputs, except for a minor increase in household income, the R^2 offers an almost total adjustment in the case of gender, presenting values of around 20–30% for the rest of the estimates. This goodness of fit attained may adjusted support the conclusions through the results reached.

Fig. 2 shows the relative importance of the independent variables in the performance of the obtained network. Questions Q07 (attend flamenco shows), Q10 (interact with people related to flamenco: singers, dancers, etc.), and Q04 (preference for classical music) appear as the most influential in the model to determine the socio-demographic profile of the tourist. Conversely, Q11 (buying products related to flamenco: musical instruments, flamenco dresses, etc.), Q09 (Flamenco is WHS) and Q14 (Flamenco increases my desire to visit certain destinations) are shown as the minor determinant.

Additionally, the network permits assessing the effect produced in each item of the socio-demographic profile that each question performs. For this purpose, the output values are taken while each value of the

Table 4
Network architecture.

Input Layer	Bias	Value = 1
	Covariates	Q01
		Q02
		Q03
		Q04
		Q05
		Q06
		Q07
		Q08
		Q09
		Q10
		Q11
		Q12
		Q13
		Q14
		Q15
		Q16
		Q17
		Q18
	Number of Units (excluding bias)	18
Hidden Layer	Rescaling Method for Covariates	Standardised
	Number of Hidden Layers	1
	Number of Units in Hidden Layer (excluding bias)	6
	Activation Function	Hyperbolic tangent
Output Layer	Dependent Variables	Gender, male = 1
		Gender, female = 2
		Age (from 16 to 73)
		Educational level (from 1 to 4)
		Household income (from 1 to 6)
	Number of Units	5
	Rescaling Method for Scale Dependents	Standardised
	Activation Function	Identity
	Error Function	Sum of Squares

Likert-type question to be analysed is modified from one to seven, while the rest remain at their mean values. The results are organised by directly dividing the questions with the most significant determination on a specific profile characteristic (Table 7) and inversely proportional (Table 8). A criterion of showing variations greater than 20% is followed for representativeness.

The questions that present stronger influence in the several items of the socio-demographic profile of tourists attending flamenco shows are shown in Table 7. Thus, there is a growing interest in attending flamenco shows (Q07) as household income increases, educational level and age profile of the respondents. Older age also implies an increasing interest in musical styles other than flamenco, such as blues (Q03) or classical music (Q04), or the importance of native music in the selection of the destination (Q02). Finally, a greater interest in body movements in flamenco shows (Q13) corresponds to a higher educational level. As household income rises, a growing interest in classical music (Q04) is also perceived.

As inversely related (Table 8), there is a decreasing interest in interacting with people related to flamenco -singers, dancers- (Q10) as income and educational level increase. Regarding age, its increase implies a decreasing interest in the search for musical experiences (Q08) and jazz music (Q06). Finally, as household income increases, both the interest in enjoying flamenco in their place of origin (Q15) and the happiness of enjoying a flamenco experience (Q16) decrease. Consequently, some similarities are observed between the results obtained in Fig. 2 and Tables 7 and 8, highlighting questions Q07, Q04 and Q10 -the latter presenting an inverse influence-as the most decisive in the model. Questions Q03 and Q13 also have a notable impact on the network obtained, which is reflected both in Fig. 2 and in Table 7.

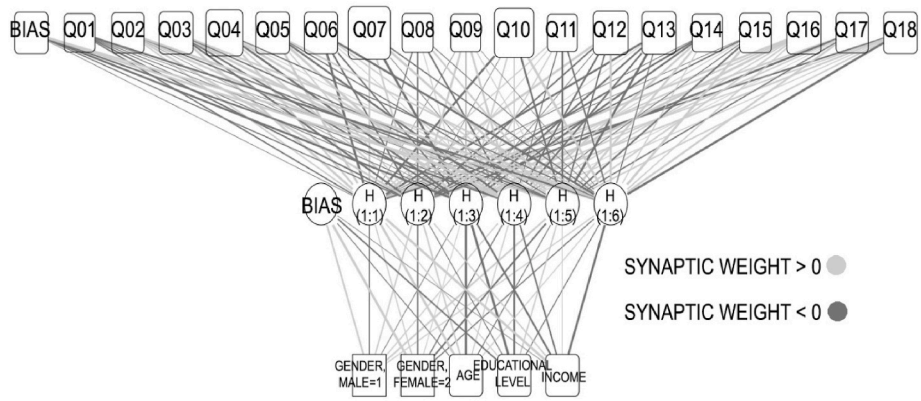

Fig. 1. Graphic representation of the ANN obtained.

Table 5
Model elaboration development.

Training (N = 193; 72.80%)	**Sum of Squares Error**		**241.417**
	Average Overall Relative Error		0.724
	Percent Incorrect Predictions for Categorical Dependents	Gender	24.40%
	Relative Error for Scale Dependents	Age	0.592
		Educational level	0.793
		Household income	0.796
	Stopping Rule Used		1 consecutive step(s) with no decrease in error (based on the testing sample)
	Training Time		00:00.1
Testing (N = 72; 27.20%)	Sum of Squares Error		109.755
	Average Overall Relative Error		0.914
	Percent Incorrect Predictions for Categorical Dependents	Gender	37.50%
	Relative Error for Scale Dependents	Age	0.797
		Educational level	0.977
		Household income	0.984

Table 6
Goodness of fit of the model obtained.

	Gender	Age	Educational level	Household income	Overall
MAPE	22.08%	29.10%	25.45%	39.71%	29.09%
R^2	96.83%	34.55%	21.92%	20.24%	43.39%

5. Discussion

The motivations and behaviours of tourists are constantly changing, seeking new destinations and traditions (Park & Santos, 2017). It should be noted how, as in García-García et al. (2023), interest in flamenco is greater as disposable income and educational level grow. In agreement with Selfhout et al. (2009), there is little interest in the type of classical music among the younger population. However, the present study detects an interest in jazz as age decreases, in contradiction to Selfhout et al. (2009). Finally, in the line of North and Hargreaves (2007), the profiles with a higher income showed a greater preference for classical music. Musical tastes can play a significant role within social contexts (Rentfrow & Gosling, 2006; Ter Bogt et al., 2011). These authors establish that personality is conditioned by these contexts or social interactions of individuals, also pointing out that the preference for a particular musical style varies depending on social status or country of residence, among other variables.

Several types of research (Jansen et al., 2009; Litvin et al., 2008; Rivera et al., 2015; Semrad & Rivera, 2018) show how the development of musical shows for certain social groups generates recommendation behaviours as electronic word of mouth. The latter is in line with the results obtained in the present investigation, where are identified the social profiles that are interested in flamenco and the atmosphere generated around the 'tablaos' (in Spanish, the flamenco stage).

6. Conclusions

Flamenco is a popular art that emerged in Andalusia with the influence of various cultures. It is a sign of identity of both Andalusia and Spain, which is evident in its great recognition both inside and outside Spain, motivating its followers to learn and enjoy it. The flamenco cultural tourist may be attracted by the emotions that both music and flamenco show arouse in them, such as the place of destination where flamenco originated. It becomes essential to discover 'tourists interested in flamenco' socio-demographic profile according to opinions, perceptions, motivations, and preferences.

This work can, in an adjusted manner, determine the direct and inverse relationships' magnitudes between these diverse flamenco tourists' opinions, perceptions, motivations with their socio-demographic profile (educational level, income, age, and gender) in an isolated way that is, considering every input/output item combination effect with each other (pairwise). Although some studies use similar procedures (Moral-Cuadra et al., 2021, 2022), even over flamenco attendants' (García-García et al., 2023), the present research is a pioneer in analysing opinions, perceptions, motivations, and preferences of tourists interested in flamenco.

6.1. Theoretical contributions

Following the theoretical contributions, the main conclusion drawn from the present research is that there is a growing interest in attending flamenco shows as educational and income level, as well as age, increase in the profile of visitors. A 'high-income' profile is essential to guarantee the business's profitability, consequently improving employment and economic growth at destination. Also, age and educational level analysis can be used to adapt touristic products and services.

However, continuing with the profile unveiling, there is a decreasing interest in interacting with singers and dancers in potential assistants with higher income and educational levels. The latter suggests a

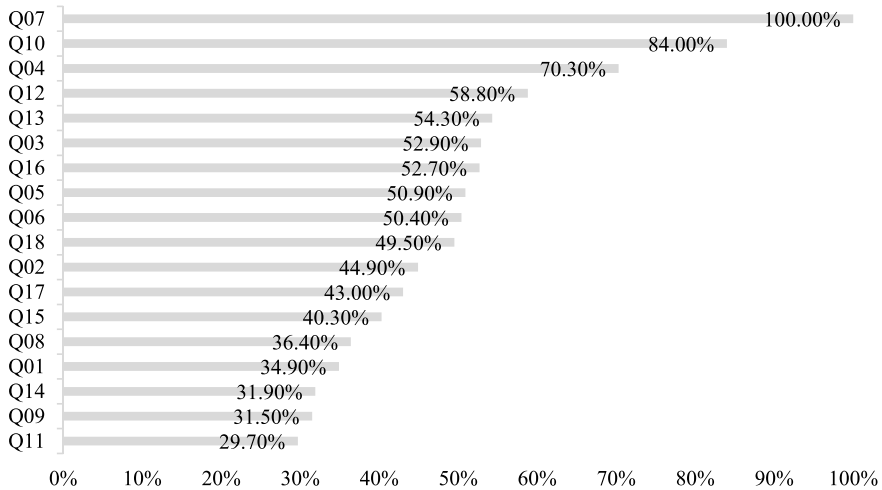

Fig. 2. Importance of independent variables in the network.

Table 7
Questions with the most direct influence on profiles' socio-demographic characteristics.

Question		Socio-demographic characteristic	Variation
Q07	Attend flamenco shows	Household income	41.28%
Q04	Classical (musical preference)	Age	38.75%
Q07	Attend flamenco shows	Educational level	37.03%
		Age	35.86%
Q03	Blues (musical preference)	Age	30.41%
Q13	Body movements (opinion about flamenco shows)	Educational level	30.23%
Q04	Classical (musical preference)	Household income	27.06%
Q02	How important is the existence of a certain type of native music when choosing the destination of your trip?	Age	23.38%

Table 8
Questions with the most inverse influence on profiles' socio-demographic characteristics.

Question		Socio-demographic characteristic	Variation
Q10	Interact with people related to flamenco: singers, dancers, etc.	Household income	−51.14%
Q18	Sports (elements that define Spain as a country)	Age	−26.71%
Q15	The possibility of enjoying flamenco in one of its places of origin is an important reason for me	Household income	−24.93%
Q10	Interact with people related to flamenco: singers, dancers, etc.	Educational level	−24.42%
Q08	Search for musical experiences as reason to know flamenco	Age	−23.84%
Q06	Jazz (musical preference)	Age	−23.34%
Q16	I feel happiness when enjoying a flamenco experience	Household income	−21.19%

preference for a tendency to take a 'mere attendant' attitude in this type of profile. It is recommended to avoid promotion oriented to this interaction with singers and dancers, trying to attract a 'higher-income' profile. Additionally, it is observed that as the attendee's income level increases, the interest in enjoying flamenco in their place of origin decreases (probably looking for alternatives such as attendance at this type of show locally or from their own home through television and the internet, for example), as well as a reduction in the feeling of 'happiness' that it brings to the viewer -prioritising other types of emotions such as passion or lure (in Spanish 'duende').

Furthermore, an explicit growing interest in the body movements that occur in flamenco dance is detected as the educational level of the assistant is higher. The latter reveals a greater willingness to gain deep knowledge of flamenco beyond mere assistance in people with advanced studies. According to age, although there is a growing taste for classical music and blues as it increases, this is not the case for jazz. There is also a decreasing interest in searching for musical experiences to get to know flamenco. To summarise, the ideal profile of the potential attendee of flamenco shows would be a person (gender was not shown to be a determining factor) of high income, middle age and advanced level of studies, who prioritises more the mere viewing of the performance (in the place of origin, but also remotely) more than the interaction with the people related to it, and that seeks to find other feelings beyond happiness when contemplating this spectacle.

6.2. Managerial contributions

As the curiosity about flamenco attendance at the destination and the feeling of happiness decreases as the tourist income increases, it is attractive to promote additional remote products other than live sessions can be interesting, such as YouTube channels, Instagram accounts, or documentaries for platforms like Netflix and Amazon Prime. These contents may bring emotions more related to passion and lure than happiness. Additionally, as tourists with elevated academic level seems more interested in flamenco dance and its body movements, it can be considered relevant, as an additional product, introductory online courses and/or seminars on the topic for university students, graduates, or higher.

6.3. Practical and social applications

In addition to the theoretical and managerial contributions, this research also presents practical and social applications. Through the generated network, a 'composite sketch' of the potential attendee of flamenco shows can be attained (stipulating their income, gender, educational level, and age) according to the values given to the ANN inputs, corresponding to the several questions about their preferences and attitudes previously made through the questionnaire. Thus, a particular set of answers will generate a specific profile type. These results ease promotion policies that best adapt to the tourists' needs whose primary or secondary motivation is enjoying flamenco shows. The latter is interesting in adapting flamenco shows and other products and

services related to a specific audience sector according to their preferences, contributing to optimising its profitability.

6.4. Limitations and future lines of work

The present research is not without limitations, among which it is worth highlighting a small number of completed surveys. In a niche market (tourists interested in flamenco), getting a high quantity of valid questionnaires is always difficult. In addition, despite a completely anonymous questionnaire, some individuals may have been reluctant to participate in studies due to privacy concerns.

On the other hand, when carrying out research related to flamenco, limitations have been found related to scientific literature sources access about the topic. The availability of relevant and updated data was affected by the gap identified in the existing scientific literature, where a lack of exploration of flamenco and its relationship with cultural tourism has been observed. In addition, it can be challenging to address all aspects of flamenco in a single study as it is a very diverse musical genre with several styles.

As future lines of work, it is suggested to broaden the spectrum of respondents to people from outside Spain, especially at a time of reactivation of tourism after the COVID-19 pandemic, to carry out questionnaires with an offer perspective (for professionals, companies, and institutions dedicated to promoting tourism), and/or approaching other types of niche tourism. The dataset employed in the present research can also be used for applying other statistical methodologies that present different types of results, such as structural equation models and/or machine learning techniques.

Also proposed as a future line of research is the use of the survey employed on tourists who have just attended a flamenco show in a destination related to it (mainly southern Spain or large capitals of the country). With this, it could be detected whether there are significant differences between the two databases obtained. This comparison would offer new information about the perceptions and emotions of tourists that could be used to establish marketing and promotion techniques for tourist destinations related to flamenco.

Additionally, it would be interesting to analyse the direct and indirect economic impact of flamenco cultural tourism in the Andalusia region. Deeping in the economic impact of flamenco events and festivals. On the other hand, research how authenticity and cultural interaction affect the satisfaction of flamenco tourists and investigate the viability and acceptance of new tourist products that integrate flamenco, such as thematic routes, workshops or experiential tours. It is essential to assess flamenco's role in preserving and promoting local culture by studying how tourism contributes to the global dissemination of flamenco as a cultural art and analysing how it can affect local communities in terms of cultural identity and social cohesion. Finally, investigate the role of public and private institutions in the international promotion of flamenco as a tourist attraction. To do this, it is suggested that comparative studies between different flamenco destinations be developed to understand the variations in terms of supply and demand.

Funding

This research did not receive any specific grant from funding agencies in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Lucía García-García: Writing – original draft, Methodology, Conceptualization. **Miguel Ángel Solano-Sánchez:** Validation, Formal analysis, Data curation. **Tomás López-Guzmán:** Writing – review & editing, Supervision, Investigation. **Salvador Moral-Cuadra:** Writing – original draft, Methodology, Investigation.

Declaration of competing interest

None.

Data availability

Data will be made available on request.

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